



phase start-ups experience as they burn through initial capital in the process of developing products and markets.

These start-ups work across emerging sectors such as GenAI, climate tech, deeptech and consumer platforms.

In this emerging playbook, venture capital is not just financing business models, but participating in the creation of new ones that

align with India's ambition of moving from a \$4-trillion to a \$10-trillion economy over the coming decade.

The first wave of India's venture capital boom, which gathered momentum after 2008-09 and helped create the likes of Flipkart and Zomato, was shaped by a fairly familiar founder profile.

Many entrepreneurs came with elite educational credentials—of-

ten IITs, IIMs or global universities—and strong professional pedigrees built at multinational companies or consulting firms.

Today's investors like Aditya Singh, co-founder of All in Capital who was also the Founding Principal of Stride Ventures, argue that those filters are becoming less relevant.

"A non-IIT student also gets funded. Back in the day, it was borderline impossible," says Singh, an MBA from IE Business School in Madrid.

The change is partly generational, says Singh. "We are young. We don't relate with someone who has 40 years of experience. We feel someone new will come and change it. So, we start backing younger folks."

All in Capital is operating its second fund with a corpus of ₹250 crore and has backed start-ups like PierSight, which is building satellites to enable persistent ocean monitoring; home decor and furnishing start-up Vaaree; and AI-powered fuel station aggregator Nawgati.

NOT EXCEPTIONS

To be sure, there have always been notable exceptions. Entrepreneurs like Ritesh Agarwal, CEO of hotel room aggregator OYO Rooms, and Kunal Shah, founder of payments firm FreeCharge and credit-card bill payment rewards company CRED, defied expectations and built category-defining businesses despite not fitting the mold of the traditional venture-backed founder.

They were outliers.

Increasingly, venture investing requires the ability to assess the underlying technology, the quality of research talent and the pace at which innovation is unfolding.

Sathya Nellore Sampat, General Partner at BoldCap Ventures, which focuses on AI investments, says,